fluids. Parkash Lal's weight slumped from a healthy 58 kg to just 36 kg. An intern, from amongst a number who visited him as a test case for research, suggested to Kiran that as there were just no facilities in the hospital she would be best advised to shift the patient to Delhi. When the principal was requested for a discharge, he had no objection and even agreed to send a doctor with them in a helicopter that Swaraj had arranged for. Yet again, they had to fly but this time straight to Guwahati (the capital of Assam) to be linked with an Indian Airlines flight. The helicopter pilot informed them that no women were allowed aboard. The matter was referred immediately to his superiors who were told that since the Peshawarias did not have any sons, they would have to make do with his daughters Kiran, Reeta and Anu, who had all come together at this moment of crisis. Permission was granted by Air Headquarters (Delhi). But the Mizoram Raj Bhavan (the governor's residence) did not sleep that night till it got the clearances! Kiran says she can't thank her colleagues enough: for instance, Prabhat Singh, Amodh Kanth, Joseph and many others who went out of the way to help her in that moment of crisis.

The pilot contacted the captain of the Indian Airlines aircraft from Guwahati to Delhi, requesting him to hold the flight for an emergency case. Kiran's batch mate, G. P. Srivastava, waited anxiously at the airport. The flight was ready for take-off when they landed and even the governor of Assam was waiting. Captain Kaul, on the Indian Airlines aircraft, assured Kiran that he would ensure a smooth flight to Delhi.

At the Delhi airport friends of the family, Kiran's brothers-in-law, colleagues and few others immediately took her father by ambulance straight to the operation theatre of the All India Institute of Medical Sciences. Dr S. N. Mehta, a brilliant surgeon, who later went to the Middle East, took charge. He told Kiran that he was very sorry to say so, but the condition of the patient was very bad and that all they could do was hope. Since her father was in a critical state, another operation could not be performed. Consequently, he was put under medication and all that the family members could do was to pray that the nick in the intestine would heal on its own.

After four months, with the family's savings almost exhausted, not to comment on the toll it took mentally and physically on the parents and their four daughters, Parkash Lal could get back on his feet. After recovering, he went on to play tennis at the Chelmsford Club courts, New Delhi.

Back in Mizoram after a long leave, Kiran gradually settled back into her daily routine as a police officer. She learnt then that while she was with her father in the hospital at Silchar, the IG (P), Lal Chhanga, various ministers and officials in Aizawl had been trying to discuss with the governor the list of the persons whom they would have to inform for the funeral in case it had to be organized there! It was immediately after this development that the governor had told Kiran to rush to Delhi with her father in yet another helicopter arranged by him with reservation connections through Guwahati. Kiran calls Swaraj her brother today: 'A friend in need is a friend indeed,' and Swaraj proved this beyond all imagination!